thames view





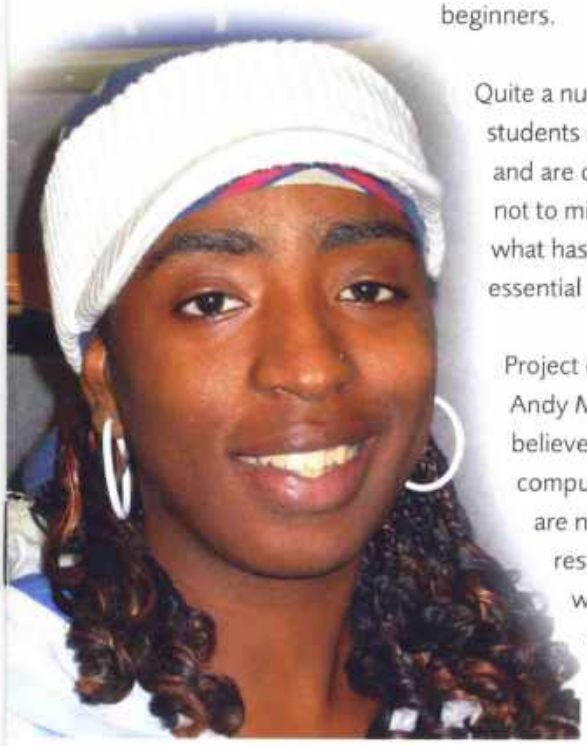
ISSUE 3

YOUR COMMUNITY MAGAZINE

APRIL 05

UK Online - accessing all areas

UK Online, a government-funded project, is bringing its travelling computer bus to Thamesmead. Now part of the Learn Direct programme, UK Online offers computer access to those that would not normally have the chance to use a computer. Launched in 2003, the name UK Online can today be seen in community centres, libraries, schools and cafes across the whole country. UK Online's bus is ideal for those areas that do not have a suitable venue for a permanent base. Packed with computers and an interactive white board UK Online's teachers specialise in teaching real beginners.



Quite a number of their students are elderly and are determined not to miss out on what has become an essential skill.

Project coordinator Andy Macdonald believes that computer skills are no longer restricted to the workplace but are part of our every day life.

He says: "Learning how to use a computer is often a stepping stone towards gaining a range of new skills. UK Online offers a no pressure environment with training tailored to meet individual needs."

Andy and his team are running an Easter Roadshow in Thamesmead. You can check out the bus and what services are on offer on Thursday 7th April. The UK Online bus will be at Broadwater in the morning and the Moorings in the afternoon. Why not go along and see what it's all about and take the first step towards learning a new skill?

Young and old

Del St. Clair is 76 years old and a retired teacher - he was determined to learn how to surf the web. Through UK Online's training, Del now manages his finances via the web using the free Internet access they provide.
Del says: "It's not easy teaching someone twice your age but my tutor Bill gave me great, tactful encouragement. Now I feel part of the computer world."

With no access to the internet, Tammy has been using UK Online's facilities since they first arrived in Haddo Street, Greenwich. "Initially I used the internet access for research and downloading music samples. Today, thanks to the bus, I am studying for a BSc in Music Technology at the London Metropolitan University. My 7-year old daughter also uses the bus and she now has an extensive knowledge of the internet."

TAVY BRIDGE TIMELINE
Stakeholders' Conference in May

COMPETITION TIME
Time for Thamesmead in Bloom

ONE TO ONE
Asian Insight

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

Tavy Bridge Timeline

With the first group of residents already moved in to their temporary accommodation, stage one of the regeneration programme is well under way. Behind the scenes at Gallions we are busy organising our stakeholders' annual conference. To be held on 24th May 2005, the conference aims to draw together all those people and organisations who have something positive to contribute to the future of Tavy Bridge.

The scale and complexity of this regeneration project means that many of the challenges can only be tackled working in partnership with others. While the skills and expertise of employment specialists and health professionals will have an enormous impact on the services available in Tavy Bridge it is you, our residents, who can shape the community's future. As a resident, you know where the problems lie and what steps should be taken to resolve them. As a stakeholder, your input is essential in ensuring we deliver what is needed to make Tavy Bridge a vibrant neighbourhood for all to enjoy. There are many opportunities for you to play an important part in this challenging yet rewarding programme of change.

The stakeholders' conference is the ideal platform for all interested parties to come along and share their ideas or simply listen to what others have to say. The entire Tavy Bridge project has been underpinned by regular consultation with our residents. The stakeholders' conference is your opportunity to help transform Tavy Bridge into a place where people choose to live. For more information about the stakeholders' conference please contact:

Linda Nash on 020 8320 3451
Mobile: 07867 526599
or email: lnash@gallionsha.co.uk



ISSUE #3

editorial

Chart Topping Thamesmead

As the weather finally turns warmer we can all begin to look forward to an exciting programme of community events. This Easter's Football festival organised by Gallions in partnership with Charlton Athletic Football Club and Bexley's Areas of Opportunity, kept some 200 local children entertained over the holiday period. Their enthusiasm and commitment to learning new skills from the professionals has reaped rewards for all involved. At Gallions we are committed to driving forward community events that all can enjoy – your support helps make these events a success.
Trust Thamesmead's plans for a summer festival to beat all others are also well under way.
Chart topping acts and fairground entertainment are just some of the things to enjoy in a day that's sure to make Thamesmead rock.

These are just some of the plans we have in the pipeline. Thamesview will keep you informed of what's happening over the coming months. If you have something to say that other residents need to hear why not give the team at Thamesview a call on 0208 320 3414.

1 **Access all areas**
Mobile internet access arrives in Thamesmead

2 **Tavy Bridge Timeline**
Stakeholders' conference in May

4 **High Flyers**
Balloons for all at Waterways nursery

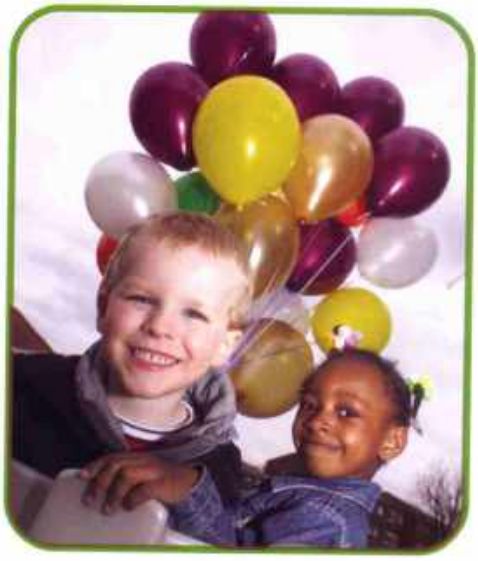
5 **Trust Thamesmead**
There's lots happening in your area

6 **Thamesmead in Bloom**
We're looking for a winning garden

8 **Dates for your diary**
What's happening and when

9 **One to One**
Asian Insight

11 **News review**
A round up of the latest news



Highflyers in Thamesmead

Thanks to the Highflying Balloon and Party Shop in Welling, the children in Thamesmead's Waterways Nursery started the Easter break on a particularly colourful note. Fifty helium balloons donated by the shop were released by the children on a very windy Thursday afternoon. The children and staff alike are now waiting eagerly to find out whose balloon has travelled the furthest. The balloon race was organised as a fund-raising event by Jill Turner, a member of Waterways staff for 18 years. With help from Nichole at the Balloon and Party Shop the children can now look forward to a trip to the zoo in the summer. The money raised will be put towards the cost of the coach hire.

Jill knows all about the perils and pitfalls of fundraising as she played a key role in getting Waterways Nursery off the ground 21 years ago. "We realised there was no local childcare for young children and started to campaign for a nursery. My husband and I ran many social events to help raise cash to open it."

Her commitment to Waterways Nursery over the last two decades is clear for all to see. Today with 18 fully qualified staff and some 40 very happy children, Waterways was thrilled when it received an excellent Ofsted report last year. Jill says: "We were delighted with the report as it reflected the hard work and dedication that everyone brings to the job every day. We are hoping to be able to expand and possibly even become a full family centre." With the drive and determination that Jill has brought to the nursery from the very early days, we are certain that Waterways will continue to go from strength to strength.



Own Your Own Home

A range of stunning one and two-bedroom apartments are now available to buy through the Gallions part buy part rent scheme. Kitted out with designer kitchens, sparkling new bathroom suites and hi-tech security systems, homeowners can enjoy riverside views from their own balconies. Why not take a look for yourself? The show home at Thames Walk, West Thamesmead is open every Saturday in April 10am to 3pm.

To book an appointment to view and to receive directions call Chris Smith on 0208 320 3494.

VISIT WWW.GALLIONSHA.CO.UK FOR DETAILS OF OUR NEW SHARED OWNERSHIP SCHEME PARK VIEW, ORPINGTON

Festival Fun in Thamesmead



This summer there is going to be a party to beat all parties – and you won't even have to leave Thamesmead to join in. Trust Thamesmead, in partnership with Gallions and Tilfen Land, is delighted to bring you the Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival 2005. So put the date and venue in your diary now. It starts at 10am on Saturday 16 July in Birchmere Park in Thamesmead and runs throughout the day until 8pm. There is a real star line up with some chart topping acts already confirmed. Entry is free and everyone is invited to come along.

The festival is also an opportunity to grab a little glory for yourself. Are you a dancing sensation, a perfect poet, a canny comedian or a fantastic flamethrower? Wherever your talent lies we have the stage for you. This year, the Festival includes a community stage with audience seating for some 300 people. What's more, one lucky act will also be selected to perform on the main stage alongside our star names.

If you think you've got what it takes, contact Danny Thorpe at Trust Thamesmead on 020 8320 4490 or email danny.thorpe@trust-thamesmead.co.uk



Scale New Heights

Under the flyover beneath Harrow Manor Way lies one of Thamesmead's best-kept secrets - the CAVE climbing wall centre. Open seven days a week and offering expert tuition at extremely competitive prices you will enjoy a first class, safe and fully supervised environment. No experience is needed and the CAVE's qualified instructors will help you all the way. As well as open climbing for all, the CAVE offers courses for individuals, schools and groups. It's fantastic fun for children's birthday parties and also ideal for a wide range of corporate activities. If you are struggling to find a different kind of present for friends and family, you can always buy them a gift voucher for some climbing sessions at the CAVE. It's great fun, great value and a fantastic way to pick up some new skills.

The CAVE is operated by Trust Thamesmead and is easily accessible from Abbey Wood railway station. For more information call the CAVE on 020 8320 4470 or 07866 741952 or email thecave@trust-thamesmead.co.uk

Thamesmead in bloom

After what seems to have been a very long winter which saw snow in March, the sun is finally shining and temperatures are rising. As we emerge from the long, dark days Team Gallions is once again on the lookout for exceptional gardens in Thamesmead. The Thamesmead in Bloom competition is now in its fifth year and we are looking for the best and the brightest in the following four categories: front garden; back garden; balcony; window box display. We know there are some great gardens out there because we have seen them.



When judging we look at all aspects of the garden, balcony or box. From tidiness and design to colour and creativity. There are no hard and fast rules for creating a winning garden - enthusiasm can transform even the most modest display. At Team Gallions we are committed to environmental issues and we are always delighted when we hear about children being involved with their garden. Teaching them that the garden is not just a place for swings and slides is an invaluable first lesson in learning about the role of plants, biodiversity and sustainable living.



To keen gardeners winning is not about prize money but about recognition for the energy and thought you have put into your garden. But we know you are a modest lot and most gardens are nominated by someone other than the gardener. If you have a friend, neighbour or family member who you think deserves to win our Thamesmead in Bloom competition please complete the form opposite. You don't even have to know the person you are nominating - if you enjoy the results of a particular garden then we will too.

Next time you are out and about in Thamesmead why not take the time to look at some of the spectacular gardens that are out there. There are 1st, 2nd

and 3rd prizes in every category as well as a small prize for the person who nominates a winning garden. Gardens give pleasure to so many people in so many different ways and here at Team Gallions we would love the opportunity to visit your garden and share your experiences. Remember, your hard work really brightens up the environment for everyone.



Gardeners' Question Time

- **If you place mulch over soil that has been soaked, it'll reduce the need for watering thereafter.**
- **If you bury bundles of old newspapers under runner beans, the water they absorb will help the beans over dry periods**
- **Barley straw placed in a pond really does help prevent algae growing (which is why Team Gallions put it into Southmere Lake each spring)**
- **If you want a young tree to grow well, don't allow grass to grow immediately around it as this will take the nutrients away from the tree**
- **The London Plane Tree doesn't support a single insect species (because of the peeling bark), and isn't native to Britain, let alone London.**



Thamesmead in Bloom entry form

Address of Garden: .....

Name of Gardener: .....

Category Entered: .....

Nominated by (Name and address if different from above): .....

.....

Please return to: Team Gallions Housing Association, FREEPOST SE6691, London SE2 9XH. No stamp required.

Keeping Thamesmead **Tidy**

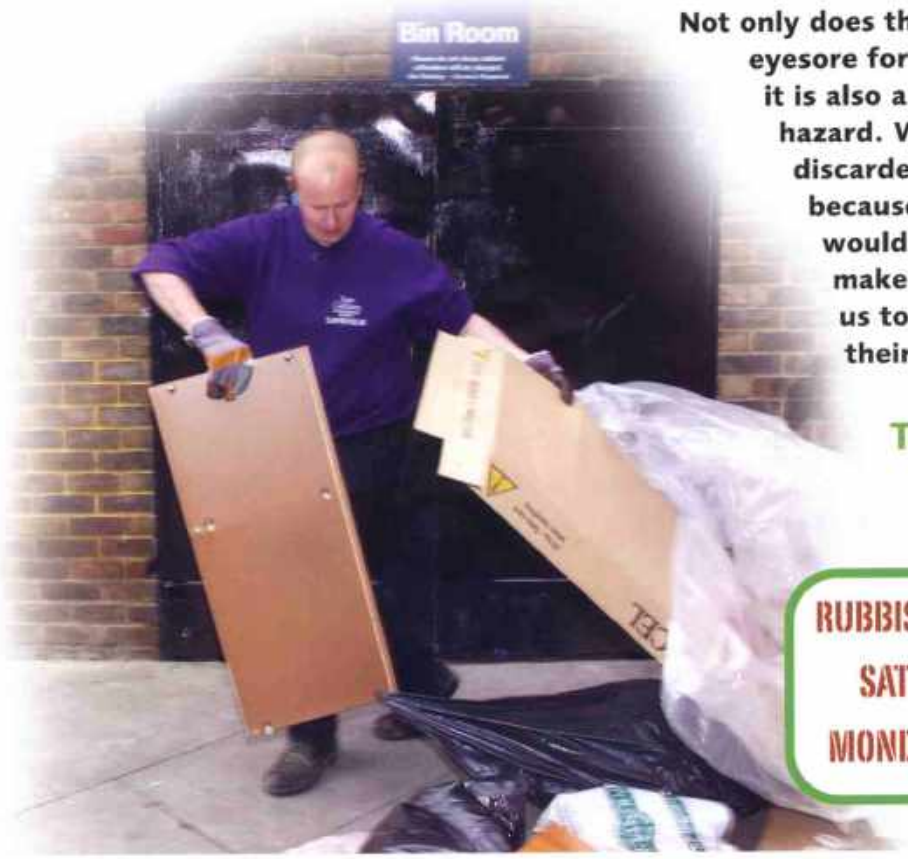
RECYCLING REMINDER



Recycling is essential for the good of the environment. The more we recycle our bottles, tins and paper the less damage we are doing to the planet. However, recycling also has a much more immediate affect on our environment - the wheelie bins don't get so full. Less rubbish on the streets means less bacteria and less vermin - now that can't be bad. Did you know that if you leave recycled waste beside the collection banks they don't get collected and don't get recycled? If you have taken the time to recycle do make sure it is in the right place to get collected.

TEAM GALLIONS ROVING RUBBISH AMNESTY

Our Rubbish Amnesty is intended not just as a service to residents who have difficulty getting their rubbish to the tip, but as a way to reduce the rubbish left on the streets by a few careless residents.



Not only does this rubbish create an eyesore for local residents but it is also a fire and health hazard. We will remove discarded household items because we have to but we would like residents to make an appointment for us to come and collect their cast offs.

Telephone:
0800 83 84 81

RUBBISH COLLECTION FIRST SATURDAY AND FIRST MONDAY OF EACH MONTH

one to one

Asian Insight

Chris Yeung, the Chairman of the London Chinese Culture and Arts Community Organisation, tells us about the goals and objectives of one of Thamesmead's most high profile community groups.

For many years the Chinese and Vietnamese community of Thamesmead have worked together to promote an awareness and understanding of their culture. In January of this year this informal group of volunteers was officially recognised at a ceremony attended by councillor Nigel Betts.

Chris Yeung says that the Chinese Culture and Arts Community Organisation (CCACO) has a number of goals - their main aim, however, is to give something positive back to the local community. His group of volunteers is committed to raising funds for such groups as the British Red Cross and local good causes. Most recently the CCACO devoted their time to raising funds for the Asian Tsunami. Their troupe of traditional dancers and colourful lion dancers are regular attractions at local events. Their role however goes far beyond their stage performances. Chris and members of the CCACO are part of the Bexley Police Community Consultative Group. Not only does the CCACO have input into such areas as neighbourhood security and anti-social behaviour but news and information from this group is translated and fed back into the Chinese and Vietnamese Community.

The CCACO welcomes anyone with an interest in oriental culture. Membership is free and Chris believes the group is an ideal environment in which to promote inclusion and encourage diversity. He believes firmly that a greater understanding and appreciation of cultural differences is the first step in delivering a greater degree of social harmony. "The CCACO is not just about promoting the oriental culture to others. It is also there to help Chinese and Vietnamese people learn about the English culture."

The CCACO will be kept busy this summer participating in the Danson Park Festival and a number of other local community events. Chris stresses however that they are keen to do more. "We want to make a positive contribution to the community and our volunteers would like to help make a difference to the neighbourhood."



Dates for your diary

UKonline internet bus in Thamesmead

Thursday 7th April

Thamesmead East Community Safety Action Zone Residents Panel

Next meeting will be held on 7th April. Come along and hear what steps are being taken to reduce levels of crime and disorder in the area. **For more information please contact Martin Hogan on 0208 320 3462 or Annette Hines of the Bexley community safety partnership on 0208 284 5507**

Police Roll Call outside shops on Manor Close

Wednesday 13th April

Wendy Mason
Tel: 0208 320 3417

Neighbourhood Forums

Crossway

Tuesday 19th April, 6.30pm Manor Close Community Hall

Lesnes, Parkview and Greenmead

Monday 25th April, 6.30 pm Atrium (Teeswater Court)

LEASEHOLDERS FORUM

Thursday 21st April 7pm. Tenants resource Centre, Harrow Manor Way. Tel; 0208 320 3424

The Thamesmead Best Neighbour Award

Everyone knows someone in the neighbourhood who is always ready and willing to help others. No problem is too big and no favour too difficult. At Gallions we want to recognise the achievements of people like this and reward their contribution to the community. We are looking for the 'best neighbour' in Thamesmead. Do you know them? Sam Robinson, last year's winner was described as a "ray of sunshine" by his friend Sandra Harris, a single mother of 6 children. Whether Sam was helping Sandra with DIY or running her home from the shops, Sam's help was invaluable. Sam's next door neighbour Dave Jessop says that "Sam has got time for everyone and he deserves this award."

If you think you know someone just like Sam who is always ready to help, please call Joy McKee on 0208 320 3414 with the name and address of the person you would like to nominate.

News Review

Join the police roll call

The Thamesmead police team will be holding a roll call outside the shops on Manor Close on 13th April. As part of a drive to open up a two-way dialogue between residents and the police, the roll call is an opportunity to hear about the pipeline projects and community news.

Sergeant Mark Ely and his team will be there also to listen to what you have to say about your neighbourhood.

Your input is vital in helping to create a safer community so why not go along to the roll call and see what's happening?



An award-winning team



Once again it's congratulations to Gallions Customer Contact Team who have scooped yet another award. Manager Tina Mercer was delighted to collect the QHS Award for accessibility on behalf of her team. She says "We are always looking at ways to deliver the best possible service we can to our residents and this award is recognition of our commitment."

Tina and her team are currently in the process of updating and checking all the details on their database. As part of this process, you may receive a phone call or even a visit from one of the team. It's worth taking the time now to confirm your details as it will save time later if you need to contact us with a query.

A word of warning

We are all guilty of simply dropping our house keys on the hall table after a long, tiring day. But it seems that this is now one of the easiest ways for burglars to gain access to your house.

Police have identified a growing trend when it comes to local robbery and are asking everyone to think about a safe place to leave their keys. Remember it only takes a few minutes to grab your keys - it takes a lot longer to replace the contents of your home.



PS. Did you know that not only is it illegal to ride mini motorcycles (gopeds) or motorised scooters on the pavement, it is also illegal to ride them on the roads. They can only be ridden on private land. Concern is growing about the problems posed to pedestrians by people using these machines on the pavement. So if your youngster owns a goped, it's a good idea to check how it is being used.



GALLIONS FREEPHONE 0800 83 84 81

Class of 2005

Funded by Bexley Adult Education, the Neighbourhood Learning Project has just completed its first series of 8-week training courses. After much hard work, and a lot of fun, the 20 students who signed up for courses at the end of last year were delighted to receive their certificates of completion from Gallions' Director of Operations, Alison Breese. All courses were free and included such subjects as beginners computer, floristry and nail art. Rosie Eaglen, Head of Curriculum at the Bexley Adult Education Centre said that another taster day and another training programme would be starting shortly. "It's important that we offer courses that you want."

Pat Wallington is just one of the students who is looking forward to putting her new skills into practice. A former hairdresser, Pat signed up to learn nail art and arrived at the certificate ceremony sporting truly impressive artwork on her own nails. Pat says " At first I was a bit nervous but everyone was very friendly and I soon became more confident. I think I've done just as well as the young ones!" Pat plans to offer a mobile nail art service and will be taking her polish, paints and brushes to parties and ladies nights around Thamesmead.



Jaswinder and Pat showing off their nails

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾。請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phong bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

PUNJABI ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐

(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

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Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Contact us

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
London
SE2 9XH

For all enquiries please contact the
Customer Response Centre
0800 83 84 81
It's a freephone number that you can use to book services, repairs or for any other enquiries.

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION